

BREATH OF LIFE

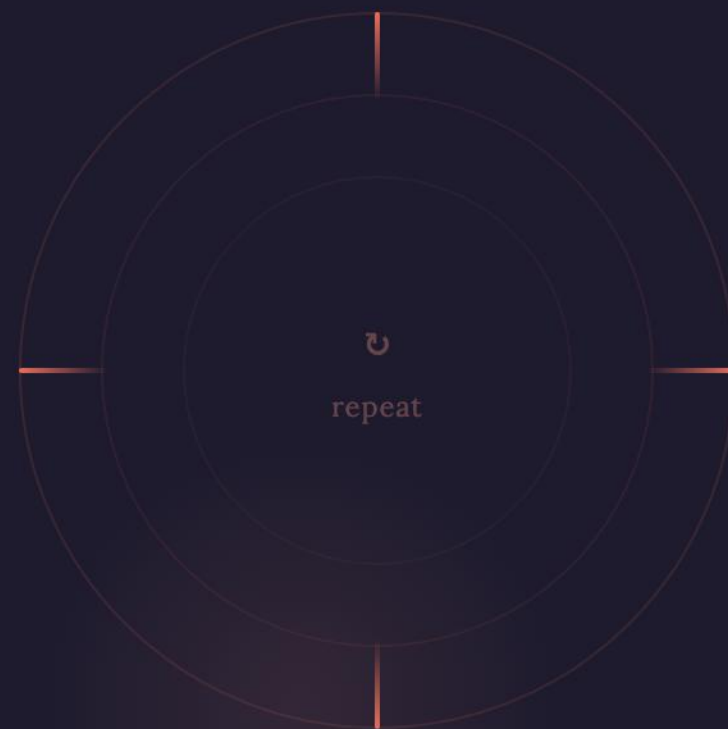
5 Loops That Make Self-Improvement Self-Sustaining

- Most improvement plateaus — not because the advice is wrong
- Single-layer improvement has a structural ceiling
- Recursive improvement fixes the process, not just the output

THE PROBLEM

The Treadmill Problem

- Read the book → start the habit → fall off → repeat
- Each new habit costs the same willpower as the last
- The second-order move: improve how you improve



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LOOP 1

Fix Your Information Diet First

- Bad inputs make every habit built on top fragile
- Switch from consuming content to consuming mental models
- Test: does this change what I read next — or only feel like progress?

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LOOP 2

Build Habit Stacks, Not Habits

- A single habit maintains momentum — it doesn't generate it
- When one behavior cues another, each link makes the next cheaper
- Find the upstream keystone — usually something physical



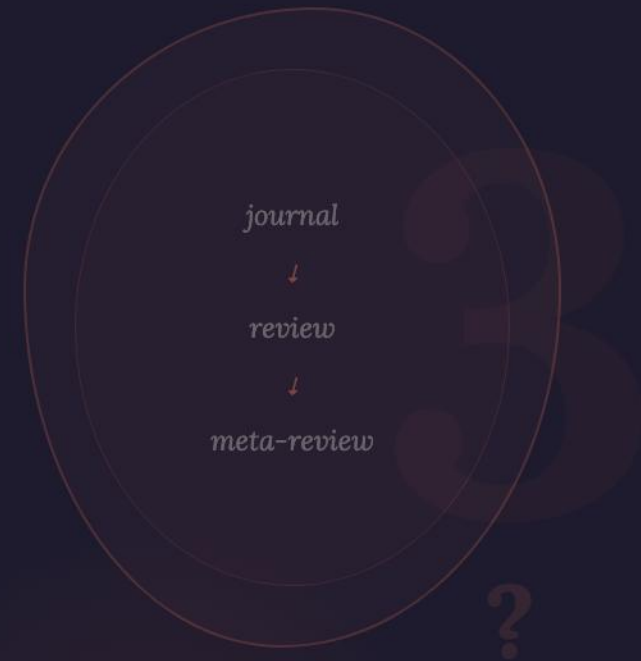
EACH LINK CHEAPER

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LOOP 3

Build a Review System That Reviews Itself

- Most journals record who you were — not who you're becoming
- Once a quarter: review your reviews, find consistent blind spots
- Meta-question: what am I not asking myself that I should be?



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LOOP 4

Find Skills That Unlock Other Skills

- Skills exist in a network — some nodes have far more edges
- Writing clearly → thinking clearly → faster learning in any domain
- High-leverage skills look soft — that's why they're underinvested



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LOOP 5

Rewrite the Identity Narrative First

- Behavior follows identity — the story you tell yourself sets your defaults
- Write who you're becoming as if it's already true + one behavior as evidence
- When identity updates, willpower becomes less relevant

"I am someone who..."

- shows up daily
- learns from failure
- invests in growth

behavior follows identity

BREATH OF LIFE

The plateau isn't a you problem. It's a level problem.

Start with the loop that's most broken for you right now.
One level up changes everything beneath it.

- Save this for when you hit your next plateau